NXTWAVE GROWTH CHALLENGE · ROUND 1 · AI WORKLOG

Three places where AI's first answer did not ship

For each: what was asked, what came back, what was changed or rejected and why, and what replaced it.

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Tool
Claude Code, Anthropic's coding agent, for the whole build: the research, the forecast model, the working asset and the slides.

Method
One session. My brief was the challenge document, the JD and one instruction: build the strongest submission an advanced student could, with the skills the JD lists.

Verification
Nothing on trust: 10 unit tests on the model, 79 browser checks on the flow, and slide numbers generated from the same model the asset runs on.

EXAMPLE 1

The channel plan and the ₹2,000

Prompt	Plan the campaign: which channels, what to do in each, and how 500 registrations come in on ₹2,000 in 7 days.
AI output	A wide plan: Campus Captains in class WhatsApp groups, a referral loop, club and placement-cell mails, LinkedIn and Instagram content, placement-update Telegram channels and a paid shout-out test. Budget in four parts: ₹1,000 captain prizes, ₹500 referrer prizes, ₹300 for the paid test, ₹200 reserve.
Changed or rejected	**Cut to one loop and three channels.** Everything paid went: even at ₹20 a lead the whole budget buys 100 registrations, and the price of a shout-out could not be verified. Content on LinkedIn and Instagram went too, because it cannot compound from a cold start inside a week. The brief also says "don't give us 20 ideas".
Final output	Captains in class and batch groups (346 direct), squad referral (190), clubs and placement cells as the buffer (56). Budget: ₹1,000 captain prizes, ₹500 for the top 5 squads, and the paid-test money folded into a **₹500 reserve that is only released on Day 4 data**.

EXAMPLE 2

The forecast

Prompt	Show, with numbers, how the 500 registrations could come in.
AI output	A referral rate of K = 0.63 (35% of registrants share, 1.8 friends each) and one confident total of about 650. A first draft of the slide also read "24 captains × 21.1 = 508", which does not multiply out.
Changed or rejected	**Rejected the K.** One number nobody can prove was carrying the plan. Cut it to 0.35 (about 30% share, 1.2 teammates each) and added cases with every rate 20% worse and better. The worse case lands at 347, which showed the real risk, so the plan was rebuilt around the one input that can be changed inside a day: active captains.
Final output	One line that can be checked by hand: 24 captains × 300 reached × 12% × 40% = 346, + 56 from partner blasts, + 190 through referrals = **592**. Cases: 347 / 592 / 936, needing 37 / 20 / 11 captains for 500. The same model sits in the asset with sliders.

EXAMPLE 3

The simulated week inside the asset

Prompt	Build one working asset that supports the plan: a referral engine with a tracker, running on sample data so a reviewer sees it working on first open.
AI output	A sample campaign that followed the plan and finished at 642 with the Day 4 decision and 539 without it. Above 500 either way.
Changed or rejected	**Rejected the flattering data.** A dashboard that only ever shows good news proves nothing about the dashboard or about me. The sample world was made worse than the plan on purpose: 11 of the 30 recruited captains never post, and clicks run 8% under plan.
Final output	A week with a real problem to diagnose. Day 4: **281 against a plan of 382**. The tracker separates supply from rates (19 of 24 captains posting, rates at plan), projects 452 if nothing changes and recommends adding captains. With that decision the week ends at **578**; with it switched off, at **454**.

What else AI suggested that did not ship

- **A WhatsApp Business API bot** for nudges and reminders. Marketing templates are billed at roughly ₹0.86 each in India, so three nudges to 592 people is about ₹1,500 of the ₹2,000. Free click-to-WhatsApp links and one announcement group do the job for this week.
- **A Google Sheets backend** bundled in but never run against real traffic. Untested code is not a working asset, so it is listed under “with another 24 hours” instead.
- **“At most three posts per group”** as a rule on the slide, while the simulated captains posted four times in the class group. Changed the rule to the one the plan actually follows: never more than one post a day in a group.

Caught by the checks, not by eye

- The day selector pushed the dashboard wider than a phone screen. A browser check at 390 px caught it.
- A screenshot for the slides showed 284 where the text said 281: test registrations had leaked into it. Retaken from a clean session, and the script now refuses any other number.
- A CSV download button that the hosting sandbox blocks. The hosted build offers copy instead.

First idea → final solution

The first idea was a landing page with a share button under a plan with about ten channels. The final is one loop with three channels, a model whose arithmetic can be checked by hand, and a tool that measures the loop and recommends one action a night. The real shift was the unit of the plan: **I stopped planning registrations and started planning active captains.**

With another 24 hours

Put both hooks in front of ten final-years from my own batch and replace the assumed click and registration rates with real ones. Move storage to a shared backend so referral codes work across devices. Wire confirmations and the three reminders in n8n. Then build the next stage of the funnel: show-up and project completion.

Sources for the two outside facts used: WhatsApp Business Platform per-message pricing for India (marketing template rate effective January 2026) and the 2026 festival calendar (Dasara 20 October, Diwali 8 November). Every other number is an assumption stated on slide 3 of the growth plan, or computed from it.